

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, dry, windy, cooler, partly cloudy, high 64. **Tonight**, clear, light winds, low 53. **Tomorrow**, dry, warmer, partly sunny, a light breeze, high 75. Weather map, Page B10.

VOL. CLXXV No. 60,900

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SATURDAY, MAY 30, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



TAKO ROBAKIDZE FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

An honor guard at the Memorial of Heroes in Tbilisi. Georgians call their country Sakartvelo, the name used in official documents.

Boat Attacks Aren’t Slowing Flow of Drugs

By SIMON ROMERO
BOGOTÁ, Colombia — With deadly precision, the Trump administration has launched dozens of attacks on small boats in the waters off South America, killing nearly 200 people in a campaign U.S. officials say is meant to curb the flow of illicit drugs to the United States.
But almost nine months into the operation, epidemiologists, addiction scientists and public health experts say cocaine, by far the top drug smuggled out of South America, is as easy to get in much of the United States as it was before the strikes began.

The findings — based on evaluations of street prices, lethal overdoses, purity of samples and drug seizures at U.S. borders — raise questions about the effectiveness of the largest U.S. military deployment in Latin America in decades.
The costs of these military operations have already climbed to \$4.7 billion, according to Brown University’s Costs of War project, including the deployment of AC-130J Ghosthunter gunships, F-35 fighter jets and guided-missile destroyers, as well as about 15,000 U.S. military personnel.
The campaign has expanded from the Caribbean Sea to include strikes in the eastern Pacific, the capture of Venezuela’s former leader to face drug trafficking charges in the United States and ground strikes in Ecuador.

President Trump’s claim that he can lawfully order the military to summarily kill people accused of smuggling drugs has come under widespread criticism. Experts in laws governing the lethal use of force have denounced the strikes as illegal because the U.S. military is not allowed to intentionally target civilians who pose no threat of imminent violence even if they are committing a crime.
But to the dismay of many addiction specialists and experts on the drug trade, Trump administration officials have quietly ramped up attacks against small boats in recent weeks with secret fixed-wing attack aircraft and armed MQ-9 Reaper drones, placing the strikes at the core of a war on drugs — one that has shifted from traditional interdiction to a strategy of direct military action.

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A.I. Seems to Be Getting Its Georgias Mixed Up

By IVAN NECHEPURENKO
TBILISI, Georgia — When Nugzar Rukhadze, an accomplished Georgian journalist, worked in Atlanta in the 1980s, he was constantly troubled by the need to explain at length that he actually came from a different Georgia.
“It was a pain in the neck,” he said in his book-laden apartment in central Tbilisi, the capital. “I would say that I am from the country of Georgia which is between Turkey and Russia on the Black Sea coast opposite Romania,” said Mr. Rukhadze, now 84. “I always had to be very wordy.”

Confusion Over Nation and U.S. State Vexes Ancient Country

Ever since it emerged as an independent nation from the ashes of the Soviet Union in 1991, Georgia, with fewer than four million people, has struggled with being confused with the more populous and prosperous American state more than 6,000 miles away.
The arrival of artificial intelligence and its use in internet searches has intensified the con-

fusion. Having a distinctive name is crucial for visibility, but search engines and the large language models that power chatbots often prioritize whatever is more frequently mentioned, creating problems for the country of Georgia and its businesses.
Sharing a name with an entity that has a much bigger digital footprint makes it a lot harder to get noticed online, said Marc Fetscherin, a professor of marketing at Rollins College in Florida who specializes in international branding.
“Algorithm replaced atlas,” he said. “Today with A.I. and with
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VIA ANDREW HAIRSTON

At a school near Houston, an officer pepper sprayed a girl fighting with her classmates, then kned her in the face.



VIA JULIAN AND MARK MONTES

This boy threw a punch during a brawl. An officer in Irving yanked him off his feet and slammed him into a metal cart.



VIA CHARLIE GINN

This 14-year-old was caught with a vape at his school in Mesquite. An officer smashed him into a wall.

At Texas Schools, Pepper Spray and Tasers

This article is by Clare Amari, Kristian Hernández and Asher Lehrer-Small.
SAN ANTONIO — Since the massacre at Robb Elementary in Uvalde in 2022, school districts across Texas have spent billions of dollars to station police officers on every campus in the state. The effort, the most ambitious in the nation, was intended to protect students from similar tragedies.
But the constant presence of officers has transformed the way many public schools manage discipline, subjecting students to

Minor Misdeeds Draw Harsh Police Tactics

heavy-handed police tactics for behavior that once would have landed them only in the principal’s office, The New York Times and The San Antonio Express-News found.
Officers in Texas displayed startling belligerence at times, grabbing or tackling students a fraction of their size over misconduct that often appeared to be mi-

nor. Children in elementary school, including one as young as 6, were handcuffed. Teenagers were arrested, charged with crimes and even jailed. In the most extreme cases, they wound up in hospitals, bruised or concussed, after being body-slammed or shocked by Tasers, which are prohibited in the state’s juvenile detention facilities but allowed in its public schools.
There is no comprehensive record of use-of-force incidents across the more than 1,000 public school districts in Texas. Many
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Courts Deal Twin Blows To Trump on I.R.S. Case And the Kennedy Center

Venue Told to Scrub President’s Name

By JULIA JACOBS and ZACH MONTAGUE
A federal judge ordered on Friday that the John F. Kennedy Center for the Performing Arts remove President Trump’s name from the building’s facade and all official branding and temporarily blocked the institution from shuttering this summer for renovations.
Mr. Trump railed against the judge’s ruling in an incensed social media post, suggesting that he was considering casting the Kennedy Center aside as one of his personal projects. The president wrote that unless he was free to decide the center’s trajectory, he had “no interest in continuing what could only be a hopeless journey.”
“Unfortunately, Judge Cooper and the Radical Left would rather see it DIE than have President Trump transform it into something that everyone could be proud of, much as I have done, in many cases, throughout my life,” he wrote.

Judge Christopher R. Cooper, of the Federal District Court in Washington, determined that the board’s decision to add Mr. Trump’s name to the Kennedy Center violated a law passed by Congress in 1964 that made “crystal clear” the institution was to be named for former President John F. Kennedy.
“Congress gave the Kennedy Center its name, and only Congress can change it,” the judge wrote in a 94-page opinion. He ordered that the 18 letters added to the center’s front portico be removed within two weeks.
The center’s board of trustees, a vast majority of whom are allies of Mr. Trump, voted in December to add the president’s name to the performing arts center. Less than a day later, new lettering was added to the building’s marble facade, which now reads: “The Donald J. Trump and the John F. Kennedy Memorial Center for the Performing Arts.”
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A Judge Questions a \$1.8 Billion Deal

By ALAN FEUER and ANDREW DUEHREN
A federal judge in Miami reopened President Trump’s \$10 billion case against the I.R.S. in a striking turnaround, saying that she wanted to investigate “grievous allegations” that the hasty deal to resolve it was “premised on deception.”
The ruling by the judge, Kathleen M. Williams, to revive the case shortly after closing it was a significant blow to Mr. Trump, who had voluntarily dismissed the suit last week, and to the Justice Department. After the president withdrew the suit, senior department officials released a pair of extraordinary agreements that settled the case by establishing a \$1.8 billion fund to compensate people who claimed they were victims of government “weaponization” by Democrats.
The deal also conferred lucrative tax benefits on Mr. Trump, his family and his businesses.
Judge Williams’s decision came in response to court papers filed on Wednesday by a bipartisan group of 35 former federal judges who urged her to bring the case back to life and dig into the details of the agreement to settle it. The former judges said that Mr. Trump’s settlement agreement raised serious questions about his “candor toward the court and manipulation of the judicial system.”
Before she closed the case, Judge Williams, an Obama appointee, had in fact questioned whether the lawsuit presented an actual conflict that she could adjudicate, given that Mr. Trump was on both sides of the suit, bringing claims against a federal agency that he controlled. When she closed it, she noted there was no “settlement of record,” but shortly after, the Justice Department released its agreement foreclosing the action.
In her brief but stern order on Friday, Judge Williams said that she wanted to investigate the circumstances surrounding Mr. Trump’s deal.
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FUNDING SLOWDOWN The National Science Foundation lifted a hold on some grants for elite universities after news media inquiries. PAGE A14
DOUBLY DISSATISFIED Frustration over the economy and foreign policy has left many voters feeling adrift from both major parties. PAGE A11

Trump’s Zigzagging Over Iran Baffles All Sides, Even His Own

By MICHAEL CROWLEY and ERIC SCHMITT
WASHINGTON — Three months after President Trump launched war on Iran, his seemingly haphazard approach to the conflict is bewildering allies at home and abroad as he veers between diplomatic dealing, military strikes and increasingly far-fetched ideas.
It is possible that Mr. Trump is near a breakthrough in the form of what both sides call an interim agreement that would reopen the Strait of Hormuz and begin detailed talks on Iran’s nuclear program. On Friday, he discussed the potential deal with his staff in the White House Situation Room but did not decide whether to approve it, according to a senior administration official who spoke on the condition of anonymity to talk about internal deliberations.
The latest diplomatic crescendo comes just after a new round of clashes between the United States and Iran tested a fragile cease-fire that has held since early April. Mr. Trump has threatened to restart the war if Iran does not reopen the strait to commercial shipping. Last week, U.S. officials hinted that he was reviewing military options for potentially resuming the bombing campaign.
But neither saber rattling nor outright shooting has derailed diplomacy between Washington and Tehran, which has continued in fits and starts in the weeks since Mr. Trump canceled a round of planned talks with Iranian officials in Pakistan early this month.
A long post on Mr. Trump’s Truth Social account on Monday typified his mixed message, declaring at once that negotiations with Iran were “proceeding nicely!” before warning that anything short of a “great deal” would mean “Back to the Battlefield and shooting, but bigger and stronger than ever before — And nobody wants that!”
At the Defense Department,
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Attendees at the Chelsea Flower Show jockeyed to buy prizewinning buds and debated the role of gnomes. PAGE A7

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The Trump administration ejected a Chinese journalist after a Times reporter was ordered to leave China. PAGE A9

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An Unhappy Swing Vote
Many Gen Z men who voted for Donald J. Trump are dismayed by his time in office. But they say Democrats don’t offer much appeal, either. PAGE A10

Located: Cheaper Gas
At a station on California tribal land, it was just \$5.39 a gallon recently. Customers relished the savings. PAGE A12

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Ben Morea, an abstract painter and anarchist, led a band of radicals with a profane name. He was 84. PAGE A20



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The country’s potato harvest set a record amid U.S. tariffs and growing competition for frozen fries. PAGE B1

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Many investors said they could not pass on an I.P.O. from a company with Elon Musk as the main attraction. PAGE B1

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Coco Gauff has rethought her mental approach to tennis as she continues to remake some of her key shots. And she’s making progress. PAGE B6

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The Spanish fought to reclaim Southern territory from the British, aiding the American cause. We follow their path along the Gulf of Mexico. PAGE C7

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Olivia Book has often stood out. Now she’s enjoying just blending as one of the first professional ballet dancers to have a limb difference. PAGE C1

